

provide a unique opportunity for manufacturers and consumers alike. In the future, a digital home can contain one or more intelligent platforms such as an advanced set-top box (STB) or a PC. These intelligent platforms can then manage and distribute rich digital content to devices like TVs and wireless monitors, and from devices like digital still cameras, camcorders, and multimedia mobile phones.

The Approach

In order to deliver on interoperability in the digital home, a common approach is required that focuses on three key elements:

- m Industry collaboration
- m Standards-based interoperability framework
- m Compelling products

The following is an overview of each of these elements.

Industry collaboration:

Alignment between key leaders in the CE, mobile, and PC industries on digital interoperability is an important first step. Historically, these industries have delivered innovative consumer products side-by-side but not necessarily in concert. None of these industries has the means to drive digital interoperability alone. However, each industry offers unique capabilities and attributes. CE and mobile device manufacturers have a history of creating new mass-market product categories, adding brand recognition, maintaining ease-of-use, and hitting attractive price points. As a complement, PC manufacturers differentiate on hardware and software development and integration. In addition, PC makers are known for delivering new products to market quickly through the development and adoption of standards. The success of a digital home interoperable network is dependent on creating new product categories and getting highly integrated devices to market quickly.

Industry collaboration is not limited to just CE, mobile, and PC manufacturers. It is an entire ecosystem of companies that together offer consumers a broad set of complementary products and services. An ecosystem properly designed for digital interoperability must start with the consumer in mind and include contributors that can help